

Dr. Christopher Dillon

Head of Data · Nexus Brands Group (PE-backed e-commerce retail)

07501 755 356
mail@christopherdillon.me
christopherdillon.me
linkedin.com/in/drchrisdillon
Northern Ireland

EXPERIENCE

Independent Consultant · Advisory & Build

2024 - Present

Selected engagements alongside in-house role

Bounded consultancy work building data functions from scratch and advising founders, CTOs, and boards. **Build:** hands-on delivery of warehouses, BI stacks, and analytics pipelines. **Advise:** architecture review, hiring, technical due diligence, AI enablement strategy. NDA-friendly, non-compete with employer's sectors. Mostly via referral.

Head of Data

Jan 2025 - Present

Nexus Brands Group — PE-backed e-commerce retail

Advocated for and created this role, then built the data strategy, infrastructure, and team from scratch across 18 businesses in a PE-backed e-commerce retail group. This function has been central to a major global restructuring and optimisation programme — providing the evidence base for strategic decisions across the group.

- **Team:** Built and lead a team of PhD-level data scientists and engineers supporting senior leadership across the group.
- **Platform (FLARE):** Designed and built **FLARE**, a centralised data warehouse and 20+ dashboard reporting solution syncing hourly from multiple NetSuite instances, Shopify, and Google. Replaced all legacy reporting with a single Streamlit stack with Entra SSO and role-based access.
- **Analytics:** Customer acquisition cost modelling and optimisation, discount dependency analysis, basket & bundle intelligence, pricing and shipping margin modelling with statistical significance testing, vendor spend analysis. EOS L10 scorecards across all departments.
- **AI:** Drove AI adoption across the group and embedded LLM-assisted development in the data team (Claude Code) for faster pipeline and dashboard delivery. Stood up self-hosted local LLMs for privacy-preserving, zero-marginal-cost workloads — review sentiment, SEO copy analysis, product description harmonisation across 18 businesses — with prompts tuned per task.
- **Business impact:** Created a unified global data view and got it into the hands of every employee at zero cost per seat, enabling: **+25% OTIF**; identified **£Xm (figure withheld)** in excess & obsolete inventory; recovered **~1% of revenue** previously lost to out-of-stock; surfaced these to support growth and directly inform the global restructuring.

European Data Scientist

Apr 2023 - Jan 2025

Nexus Brands Group

Built the data function from scratch for 5 European businesses across tattoo, beauty, and pet grooming supply. Consolidated fragmented data sources into a unified data warehouse, enabling consistent automated reporting across all entities. Promoted to Head of Data based on this work.

Data Scientist

May 2022 - Apr 2023

Christies Direct (now part of Nexus Brands Group)

Established the Data Science function from scratch at one of the world's largest pet-grooming supply companies. Created unified reporting across Christies and sister company Transgroom. Promoted to European Data Scientist as the business was acquired into Nexus Brands Group.

Research Fellow

Jan 2022 - Apr 2022

Queen's University Belfast & Randox Laboratories

Post-doctoral position to hand over the biomedical image recognition work from my PhD into Randox's production pipeline. Developed bespoke feature recognition software for biochip designs and created technical documentation for biomedical colleagues.

Astrophysics PhD

Sep 2017 - Feb 2022

Queen's University Belfast

PhD project: *Observations and Modelling of Intensity Time series for Biomedical and Astrophysical Applications* — joint venture between Queen's and Randox. Developed statistical techniques for below-noise-floor signals, applied to both stellar lightcurves and biochip diagnostics. Led to novel discoveries of stellar nanoflares (published in ApJ) and to image feature recognition software now embedded in Randox's biochip pipeline — **98.8%** reduction in downstream processing time in a **\$12B** diagnostics market. Primarily IDL and Python. Redacted thesis.

PUBLICATIONS

2023	Nanoflare Activity on Fully Convective M-dwarf Stars Grant et al. The Astrophysical Journal
2020	Statistical Evidence for Stellar Nanoflare Signals in M-type Lightcurves Dillon et al. The Astrophysical Journal
2019	Monte Carlo Techniques for Nanoflare Detection in Solar Active Regions Jess et al. The Astrophysical Journal

SKILLS

BUILD

Python
SQL
Polars
DuckDB
Streamlit
Docker
Git
Claude Code
Local LLMs
Prompt engineering
LEAD
Data strategy
Hiring
Team development
Stakeholder management
Cross-functional delivery

SHIP

Swift / SwiftUI
Indie Mac and iOS apps (Pascal, Nyquist)

EDUCATION

MSci Physics, First Class Honours

Queen's University Belfast

Sep 2013 - Jun 2017

Seagate bursary recipient. Head of peer mentor scheme.